

WINDOWS 8: MICROSOFT'S SILVER BULLET

A lot rides on the success of Microsoft's knight in shining armour. No pressure, eh?

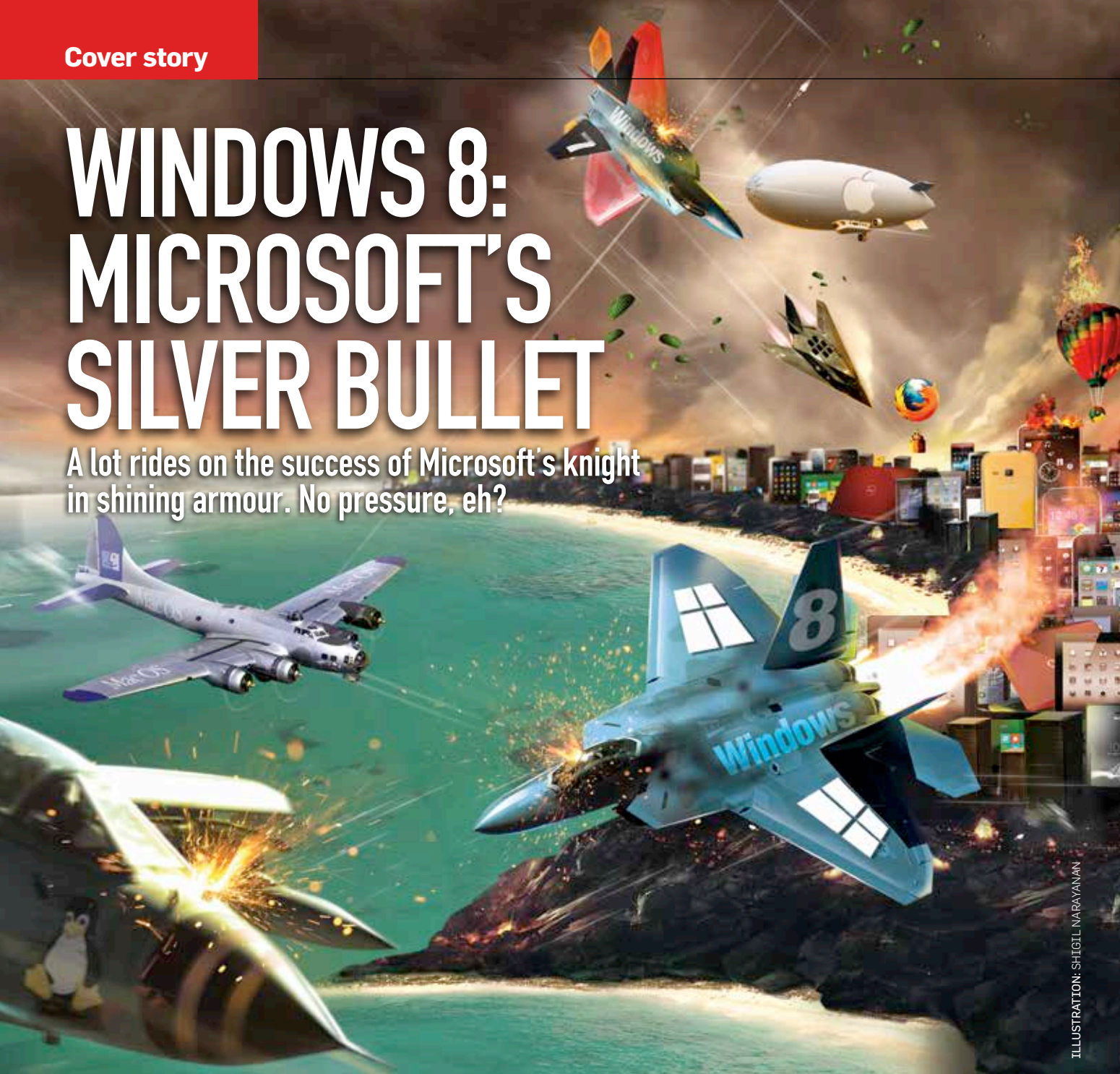


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Oh, how the mighty have fallen! Ever since the era of personal computing began, Microsoft and its trusted operating system has been ruling the roost. Right until Windows XP, and for close to two decades, the Windows juggernaut has gone from strength to strength, blowing the competition away and getting everyone hooked. A software vendor that had morphed into an endless tech monopoly, exerting control over a global digital marketplace. This was

true up to 2007. For within a decade, how things have changed! More people now buy smartphones and tablets than PCs, and Microsoft's superstar OS – complacent and lacking fresh ideas – is dropped for Apple and Google's spiffy new entrants. Like a rude awakening from a sweet, satisfying teenage dream, Windows realizes that the era of dull and boring boxes hooked to your desks is gone. Prom is over, and victory in past battles count for little, as a new frontier war looms large. At stake is the very essence of personal computing and its new definition. This is a make or break moment in the history of the Redmond giant, a fateful

throw of the dice. With so much at stake, Windows 8 couldn't have picked a more turbulent time to flag off. After this, there's no turning back.

Windows re-imagined

Fresh out of the oven, and garnering steady acclaim worldwide, Microsoft has much to cheer and be cautious about with Windows 8. It is the most ambitious face-lift the operating system has had ever received since Windows 95. Not just cosmetic changes, Windows 8 also carries certain programming traits that differentiate it from previous releases – it has a hybrid kernel and